

- Supports multiple user access
- Provides secure data transfer when changing notebooks
- Secure challenge-response password recovery

This pretty much takes care of all the drawbacks we mentioned for the “encrypt with one right-click” type of software we described earlier.

Such functionality doesn’t come free, of course: Reflex DataVault will set you back by £55 (Rs 4,800). Could be worth it if you’re the paranoid type, or if you’re the executive type who seriously can’t afford someone taking a sneak-peek into your stuff.

5.2 Keeping Passwords Safe

Some of us just remember our passwords, even if they’re as ridiculously uncrackable as “gb65end0x”, and even if there are many of them to remember. Some of us are naïve enough to use passwords like “azsxdc”, and have trouble remembering even those! If you fall in the second category, forget it—someone’s going to steal your data soon enough. No, seriously, what one needs is good, strong passwords, and password management software to keep them safe.

A “strong” password is one that has a sufficient number of characters—some say anything over eight will do—and a mix of lower-case, upper-case, and special characters. On top of that, there’s the issue of multiple passwords: if you set the same password for everything, there could be a problem. What if your Windows XP and your Gmail password are the same, and a friend of yours wants to access your machine? And then what if you gave him the password to your machine, and he went ahead and tried it on your Gmail account as well? Multiple passwords are, therefore, important. And it’s tough to remem-